

and physical experiences enhances the online shopping journey, increases customer satisfaction, and opens up new avenues for personalised marketing and product visualisation.

Healthcare and telemedicine: In the realm of healthcare, hyper-real platforms can revolutionise telemedicine and patient care. Virtual consultations can be conducted within hyper-realistic environments, allowing healthcare professionals to interact with patients in a more immersive and intuitive manner. Hyper-real platforms also enable medical simulations, where doctors can practice complex procedures and scenarios in virtual environments. This technology enhances medical training, facilitates remote collaboration among experts, and improves patient outcomes by enabling accurate diagnosis and treatment.

Economic opportunities and business models

Hyper-real platforms, that aim to create highly realistic and immersive experiences, play a crucial role in unlocking the full potential of the metaverse. Some of the economic opportunities in implementing hyper-

real platforms with the metaverse are detailed below (see Table 2).

Virtual real estate and property development: One significant economic opportunity in the metaverse lies in virtual real estate and property development. Hyper-real platforms enable the creation of lifelike virtual environments that can be owned, developed, and monetised. Entrepreneurs and businesses can acquire virtual land and build virtual properties, including homes, commercial spaces, entertainment venues, and more. These virtual assets can be leased, rented, or sold to other users, creating a virtual real estate market and opening avenues for property development, design, architecture, and virtual construction services.

Digital goods and virtual asset marketplace: Hyper-real platforms offer a thriving marketplace for digital goods and virtual assets within the metaverse. Users can create, buy, sell, and trade a wide range of virtual items, including clothing, accessories, vehicles, artwork, and more. Artists, designers, and content creators can leverage hyper-real platforms to design

and sell virtual products, tapping into a global market of metaverse users. Additionally, the scarcity and exclusivity of limited-edition virtual assets can drive demand and create unique economic opportunities.

Virtual events and experiences: Hyper-real platforms provide a fertile ground for hosting virtual events and experiences. Businesses can organise concerts, conferences, exhibitions, and immersive storytelling experiences within hyper-realistic virtual environments. Virtual event organisers can generate revenue through ticket sales, sponsorships, merchandise, and partnerships. Hyper-real platforms offer unique advantages, such as global accessibility, reduced logistical constraints, and the ability to create memorable and interactive experiences that transcend physical limitations.

Advertising and brand integration: As the metaverse becomes more populated and immersive, advertising and brand integration present significant economic opportunities. Brands can leverage hyper-real platforms to create immersive advertising campaigns, product placements, and

Economic opportunities	Business models
Virtual real estate and property development	Virtual land acquisition and development
	Virtual property rental and sales
	Virtual construction and design services
Digital goods and virtual asset marketplace	Creation and sale of virtual products
	Virtual asset trading and auctions
	Limited edition virtual collectibles
Virtual events and experiences	Virtual event organisation and ticket sales
	Sponsored virtual experiences and exhibitions
	Virtual event merchandise and partnerships
Advertising and brand integration	Immersive virtual advertising campaigns
	Branded virtual environments and experiences
	Virtual product placements and sponsorships
Virtual services and consultation	Virtual consulting and expert services
	Virtual training and mentorship programs
	Personalised virtual services and advice
Platform development and infrastructure	Development of hyper-real platforms
	Infrastructure and maintenance services
	Tools and asset creation for platforms

Table 2: Economic opportunities and business models of hyper-real platforms

Continued to page...34